

Chapter

Interpretation Of Topographical Maps

1. What is the definition of a contour line on a topographical map? MAIN 2023

- (a) A line that connects areas of equal population
- (b) A line that connects points of equal elevation
- (c) A line representing rivers
- (d) A line that marks forest areas

2. What is meant by the term 'contour interval'? MAIN 2021

- (a) The difference in height between two consecutive contour lines
- (b) The distance between the base and the summit of a mountain
- (c) The total elevation of the landform
- (d) The distance between the map and the real-world location

3. What type of settlement pattern is typically found in areas with irregular terrain? MAIN 2022

- (a) Nucleated
- (b) Linear
- (c) Dispersed
- (d) Circular

4. What are cardinal points ? MAIN 2024

5. Classify the maps on the basis of scale. SQP 2022

6. What is a 'Contour' ? COMP 2022

**7. What does a dendritic drainage pattern indicate about the land ?
MAIN 2021**

8. How does radial drainage pattern develop ? SQP 2023

9. What is four-figure grid reference ? SQP 2023

10. Explain the four basic types of settlement pattern. MAIN 2024

11. What information do we get from a map ? MAIN 2023

12. What do the contour lines represent ? COMP 2021

13. What are spot heights ? Why are they widely used in hilly regions ?
MAIN 2022

14. What is Grid ? Give the importance of National Grid. COMP 2022

15. How do contour lines show different slopes of land? MAIN 2021

Solution

1. (b) A line that connects points of equal elevation

On a topographical map, a contour line joins all points that have the same height above sea level, showing the shape and elevation of the terrain.

2. (a) The difference in height between two consecutive contour lines

The contour interval is the vertical distance or difference in elevation between two successive contour lines on a map.

3. (c) Dispersed

In areas with irregular or hilly terrain, settlements are usually spread out rather than clustered, forming a dispersed pattern to adapt to the uneven landscape.

4. **Cardinal points** are the four main directions on a compass or map, used for navigation and orientation. They are:

- North (N)
- South (S)
- East (E)
- West (W)

5. Maps can be classified on the basis of scale into two types:

- **Large-scale maps** – show a small area in great detail.
- **Small-scale maps** – cover a large area but with less detail.

6. A **contour** is an imaginary line drawn on a map that connects points of the same elevation above sea level.

7. A **dendritic drainage pattern** indicates that the land has **soft, uniform rock or soil**, allowing rivers and their tributaries to flow in a tree-like branching pattern.

8. A **radial drainage pattern** develops when streams **flow outward from a central elevated point**, such as a **dome, volcanic cone, residual hill, or tableland**, giving a spoke-like appearance.

9. A **four-figure grid reference** identifies a specific **grid square** on a map using **two digits for the easting** and **two digits for the northing**. It shows the square where the vertical and horizontal lines intersect. For example, **3245** refers to the square at easting 32 and northing 45.

10. The four basic types of settlement patterns are:

1. **Nucleated** – Buildings are clustered together around a central feature like a market, church, or river.
2. **Dispersed** – Buildings are spread out over a large area with space in between, common in rural farming regions.
3. **Linear** – Settlements arranged in a line along roads, rivers, or coasts, following natural or man-made routes.
4. **Radial** – Settlements arranged around a central point, with roads or features radiating outward from the center.

11. From a map, we can obtain information about the location of places and landmarks, physical features like mountains, rivers, and plains, political boundaries such as countries and states, human activities including settlements, roads, and land use, elevation and relief through contour lines, navigation and directions using cardinal points and distances, and details about climate and vegetation. Maps provide a visual representation of both natural and human-made features of an area.

12. Contour lines show the elevation and shape of the land on a map. Each line joins points at the same height above sea level, indicating the slope and relief of the terrain. Closely spaced lines show steep slopes, while widely spaced

lines show gentle slopes. They help identify hills, valleys, ridges, and depressions.

13. Spot heights are points on a map marked with a dot and a number indicating the exact elevation of that location in meters or feet. They are widely used in hilly regions to provide precise reference points for navigation, construction, and understanding the terrain's elevation in areas with uneven or rugged land.

14. A grid on a map is a network of horizontal and vertical lines that divides the map into squares, allowing specific locations to be identified using coordinates. The National Grid is important because it provides a standardized system for accurately locating places across the country, helps in navigation, mapping, and planning, and ensures consistency when representing geographic information on maps.

15. Contour lines show the slope of the land by the spacing between them. When the lines are close together, the slope is steep, because the elevation changes rapidly over a short distance. When the lines are spaced far apart, the slope is gentle, as the elevation changes gradually. By observing the pattern and spacing of contour lines, we can visualize the steepness and shape of the terrain.